



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – Tpr. Levi Champion #982

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 3-Cartersville

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00160953

Related Crash Reports: None ; _____ ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: No

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 02/07/2024

Time: 1440 hours

Location: Conference call

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Captain Shawn Prather #11, Sgt. Stephen Langham #192 and Tpr. Levi Champion #982.

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 1/19/2024

Time: 2238 hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

Tpr. Levi Champion #982 was stationary on GA 20 just west of Interstate 75 monitoring traffic when he observed a speeding vehicle. The vehicle was a dark colored sedan and Tpr. Champion confirmed his observations via RADAR (73 MPH in a 45 MPH zone). Tpr. Champion proceeded to intercept the suspect with all emergency equipment activated and the suspect accelerated, initiating a pursuit.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If needed, list:

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A

If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion observed a traffic violation and attempted to intercept the suspect to conduct a traffic stop. Once it was obvious the suspect was fleeing, he informed the Troop A Communications Center, while also providing pertinent pursuit information. The Troop A Communications Center received this information and created a CAD call for the pursuit.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☐ Yes

☒ No

If no, explain: Tpr. Champion only had a general description of the vehicle and no tag number. Tpr. Champion wasn't able to get close enough to the suspect's vehicle to determine the number of occupants or their description.

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A

Explain: Once Tpr. Champion advised that he was in a pursuit, Troop A Dispatchers cleared the radio for emergency traffic before conducting a broadcast of the pursuit to all Troop A Troopers. The Troop A Communications Center also notified the Bartow County Sheriff's Office of the pursuit.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If no, explain: Tpr. Champion did communicate, but improvement in communicating his observations is needed.

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on I-75 southbound near mile marker 290. The pursuit continued south on Interstate 75 and terminated near mile marker 283. The pursuit lasted for approximately 2 minutes, 53 seconds, and traveled a total distance of approximately 7 miles.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The suspect's actions during the pursuit supported a felony charge of fleeing and attempting to elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☐ Yes ☒ No If no, explain: Tpr. Champion needs to improve on communicating his observations.

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☐ Yes ☒ No If no, explain: Tpr. Champion needs to improve on commentator driving.

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☐ No If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion experienced an adrenalin rush during the pursuit.

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☒ N/A Explain:

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A Explain: Tpr. Champion properly activated his blue lights and siren as he attempted to intercept the suspect. Tpr. Champion discontinued the pursuit once he lost visual contact with the suspect.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during nighttime hours with clear skies and the roadway surface was dry. The traffic conditions on Interstate 75 southbound would be described as moderate.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion lost visual contact with the suspect and discontinued the pursuit.

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion lost visual contact with the suspect and discontinued the pursuit.

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator fled at high speeds and deactivated his lights as he fled in a high speed reckless manner. This posed a great risk to the public and all involved.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion lost visual contact with the suspect and discontinued the pursuit.

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: This pursuit was Tpr. Champion's 2nd pursuit of his career.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion has received EVOC and Advanced EVOC Training. He has also received the annual Pursuit Liability Training and the PIT Refresher Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion properly activated his blue lights and siren as he attempted to intercept the suspect. Tpr. Champion discontinued the pursuit once he lost visual contact with the suspect.

2. Areas for improvement.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Tpr. Champion needs to improve on commenorator driving and communicating his observations during pursuits.

3. Other considerations.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.

☐

N/A

If Yes, explain: Sgt. Langham coached Tpr. Champion on the importance of commentating and communicating his observations during pursuits.

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.

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N/A

If Yes, explain: A coaching session was held with Tpr. Champion on the importance of commentating and communicating his observations during pursuits. We also reviewed the Departmental procedure to discontinuing a pursuit and the importance of leaving your in-car camera system recording to fully capture the termination.

Captain Shawn Prather #11

Reviewing Officer



2/13/2024

Date